
HOW TO LEAVE YOUR BANK FOR A COMMUNITY BANK

Fellow queer author Dannielle Owens-Reid wanted to give their money to someone other than a white male executive and/or a big corporation so they took their accounts out of Bank of America and put their money into Broadway Federal Bank, a local Los Angeles black-owned bank. Here's how you can make a similar switch.

1. Make sure the local bank meets the requirements for your life. Dannielle needed a bank that could handle business accounts and found only one local black-owned bank that could, so the decision was essentially made.
 2. Be prepared to spend some time at the bank both personally and virtually. Make friends! In terms of personal service, Dannielle said the man in charge of their account at the local bank waives the \$12 fee on their business account (which is charged if it falls below \$1,000) if they call him and ask. At Bank of America, Dannielle said their business account was charged \$16 every time it fell below \$2,000, which happened often as it's a new business. Over the business's first two years, they said, it cost them hundreds of dollars.
 3. Know you're buying local. Dannielle's bank operates only in LA, which they love because they are contributing to their own community.
 4. Ask about ATMs. Dannielle's new bank doesn't have its own ATMs, but it is connected to STAR ATMs, which are common in Los Angeles. Some places reimburse ATM fees, so ask about that. (This would help me when I drunkenly take out \$20. JK. I don't do that anymore.)
 5. Beware the skeptics. Lots of people will say what you're doing is "inconvenient." But lots of things that are morally right are inconvenient.
 6. Remain resolute. Your old bank may try to get you to stay by telling you about new features you can get on your account or other bargaining chips. Dannielle chose to tell the account manager the real reasons they were leaving, but you can be less confrontational than that. (Ha!)
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